Building and evaluation of a PBPK model for vancomycin in adults

Version	**1.1-OSP9.1**
based on *Model Snapshot* and *Evaluation Plan*	https://github.com/Open-Systems-Pharmacology/Vancomycin-Model/releases/tag/v1.1
OSP Version	9.1
Qualification Framework Version	2.2

This evaluation report and the corresponding PK-Sim project file are filed at:

https://github.com/Open-Systems-Pharmacology/OSP-PBPK-Model-Library/

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1 Introduction

The presented model building and evaluation report evaluates the performance of a PBPK model for vancomycin in adults.

Vancomycin is a glycopeptide antibiotic related to ristocetin that inhibits bacterial cell wall assembly and is used to treat a number of bacterial infections. It can be administered intravenously, as well as orally in case of diarrhea therapy. Vancomyin is mainly eliminated via glomerular filtration (GFR). A previous PBPK model for vancomycin using PK-Sim was reported by Radke et al. (Radke 2017), with the dose fraction extreted unchanged into urine in adults beeing 90% with 10% hepatic elimination. Our final vancomycin model was rebuild that applies only GFR mediated clearance that adequately described the pharmacokinetics in adults. No further improvement of vancomycin pharmacokinetics could be determined after introducing hepatic clearance.

The vancomyin model is a whole-body PBPK model, allowing for dynamic translation between individuals. The vancomyin report demonstrates the level of confidence in the vancomyin PBPK model build with the OSP suite with regard to reliable predictions of vancomyin PK in adults during model-informed drug development.

2 Methods

2.1 Modeling strategy

The general concept of building a PBPK model has previously been described by Kuepfer et al. (Kuepfer 2016). Relevant information on anthropometric (height, weight) and physiological parameters (e.g. blood flows, organ volumes, binding protein concentrations, hematocrit, cardiac output) in adults was gathered from the literature and has been previously published (PK-Sim Ontogeny Database Version 7.3). The information was incorporated into PK-Sim® and was used as default values for the simulations in adults.

The applied activity and variability of plasma proteins and active processes that are integrated into PK-Sim® are described in the publicly available PK-Sim® Ontogeny Database Version 7.3 (Schlender 2016) or otherwise referenced for the specific process.

First, a base mean model was built using data from the single dose escalation study to find an appropriate structure describing the PK of vancomycin. The mean PK model was developed using a typical European individual. Unknown parameters were identified using the Parameter Identification module provided in PK-Sim®. Structural model selection was mainly guided by visual inspection of the resulting description of data and biological plausibility.

Once the appropriate structural model was identified, additional parameters for different formulations were identified, if available.

A final PBPK model was established and simulations were compared to the reported data to evaluate model appropriateness and to assess model qualification, by means of diagnostics plots and predicted versus observed concentration-time profiles, of which the results support an adequate prediction of the PK in adults.

During model building, uncertainties in data quality, as well as study differences may cause not being able to adequately describe the PK of all reported clinical studies.

2.2 Data used

2.2.1 In vitro / physico-chemical data

A literature search was performed to collect available information on physicochemical properties of vancomycin. The obtained information from literature is summarized in the table below, and is used for model building.

Parameter	Unit	Vancomycin literature	Description
MW	g/mol	1449.3 (Radke 2017)	Molecular weight
pKa		Acid 2.18, Base 7.75, Base 8.89 (Radke 2017)	Acid/base dissociation constant
Solubility (pH)	mg/L	225 (Drugbank.ca)	Solubility
logP		-4.41 (Zhou 2016), 1.11 (Drugbank.ca), 2.45 (Radke 2017)	Partition coefficient between octanol and water
fu		0.48 (Zhou 2016), 0.67 (Radke 2017)	Fraction unbound
GFR	µM	- (Zhou 2016)	Glomerular filtration rate
Hepatic clearance	mL/min/kg	0.11 (Radke 2017)	Hepatic clearance
Renal clearance	mL/min/kg	0.95 (Radke 2017)	Renal clearance

2.2.2 Clinical data

A literature search was performed to collect available clinical data on vancomycin in adults.

The following publications were found in adults for model building and evaluation:

Publication	Study description
Boeckh 1988	Pharmacokinetics and serum bactericidal activity of vancomycin alone and in combination with ceftazidime in healthy volunteers
Healy 1987	Comparison of steady-state pharmacokinetics of two dosage regimens of vancomycin in normal volunteers

2.3 Model parameters and assumptions

2.3.1 Absorption

Only intravenous data was available for model building.

2.3.2 Distribution

Sun et al. (Sun 1993) reported that albumin and immunoglobulin A are the dominant binding protein of vancomycin, and that vancomycin does not bind to Alpha-1 acid glycoprotein (AAG). As in PK-Sim there is only option to bind to albumin or AAG, vancomycin binding is built-in as bound to albumin only in the PBPK model. The fraction unbound (fu) of Vancomycin is built-in as 0.67 as reported by Radke et al. (Radke 2017).

After testing the available organ-plasma partition coefficient and cell permeability calculation methods built in PK-Sim, observed clinical data was best described by choosing the partition coefficient calculation method by Schmitt, and cell permeability calculation method by Charge dependent Schmidt . Specific organ permeability normalized to surface area was automatically calculated by PK-Sim.

2.3.3 Metabolism and Elimination

A previous PBPK model for vancomycin using PK-Sim was reported by Radke et al. (Radke 2017) , with the dose fraction excreted unchanged into urine in adults being 90% with 10% hepatic elimination. Zhou et al. (Zhou 2016) also published a PBPK model for vancomycin introducing an unknown hepatic clearance process being roughly 20% of total elimination. Our final vancomycin model was rebuilt that applies only GFR mediated clearance that adequately described the pharmacokinetics in adults. No further improvement of vancomycin pharmacokinetics could be determined after introducing hepatic clearance.

3 Results and Discussion

The PBPK model **vancomycin** was developed with clinical pharmacokinetic data covering intravenous administration with a dose range of 500-1000mg, including single dose (SD) as well as multiple dose (MD) clinical data.

During the model-fitting, the following parameters were estimated (all other parameters were fixed to reported values):

- Lipophilicity

The fit resulted in an adequate description of all data. As only limited amount of data was available, and the description of the data was adequate, an additional inclusion of hepatic clearance did not further improve the description of the data as proposed in other published PBPK models, and is therefore not included in the model. Further available data could be used to further evaluate the model performance.

The model results show that the PBPK model of vancomycin adequately described the data for intravenous administration for single and multiple dose.

3.1 Vancomycin final input parameters

The compound parameter values of the final vancomycin PBPK model are illustrated below.

Compound: Vancomycin

Parameters

Name	Value	Value Origin	Alternative	Default
Solubility at reference pH	225 mg/l	Internet-Drugbank	Drugbank	True
Reference pH	7	Internet-Drugbank	Drugbank	True
Lipophilicity	2.2307891407 Log Units	Parameter Identification-Parameter Identification	LogP	True
Fraction unbound (plasma, reference value)	0.67	Parameter Identification-Parameter Identification	Measurement	True
Is small molecule	Yes			
Molecular weight	1449.3 g/mol	Publication-Other-Radke 2017		
Plasma protein binding partner	Albumin			

Calculation methods

Name	Value
Partition coefficients	Schmitt
Cellular permeabilities	Charge dependent Schmitt

Processes

Systemic Process: Glomerular Filtration-Zhou et al. 2016 GFR

Species: Human

Parameters

Name	Value	Value Origin
GFR fraction	1	Publication-Other-Zhou 2016

Systemic Process: Total Hepatic Clearance-Radtke 2017

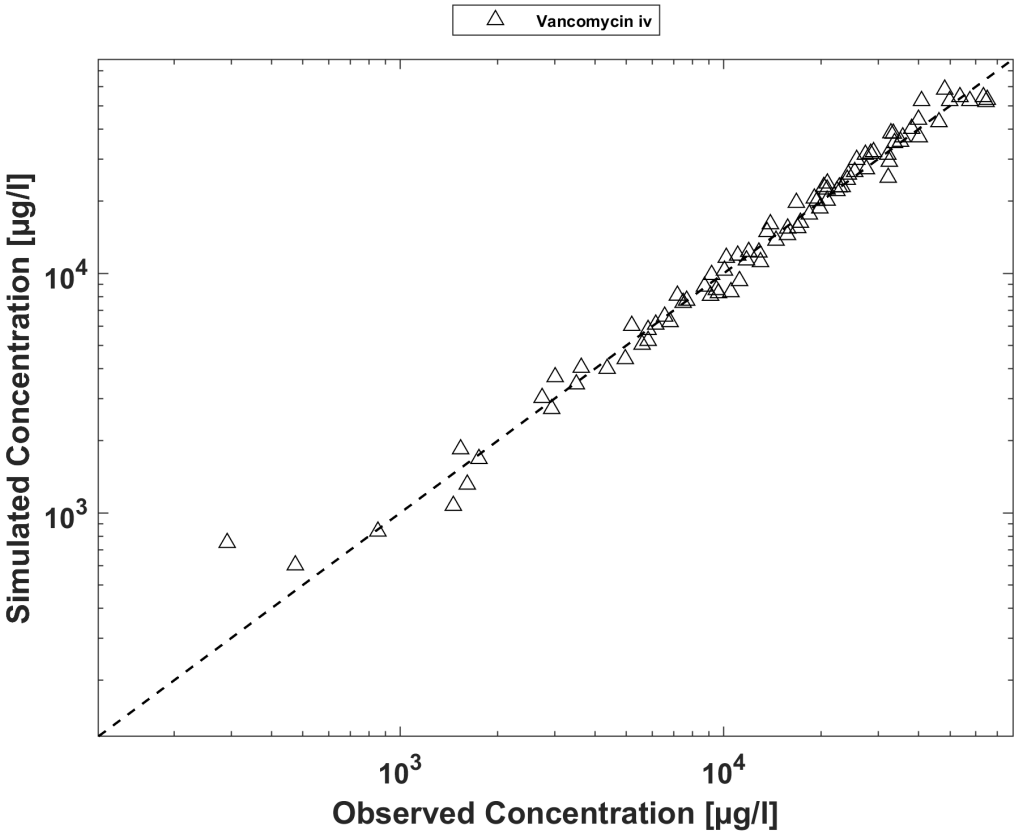
Species: Human

Parameters

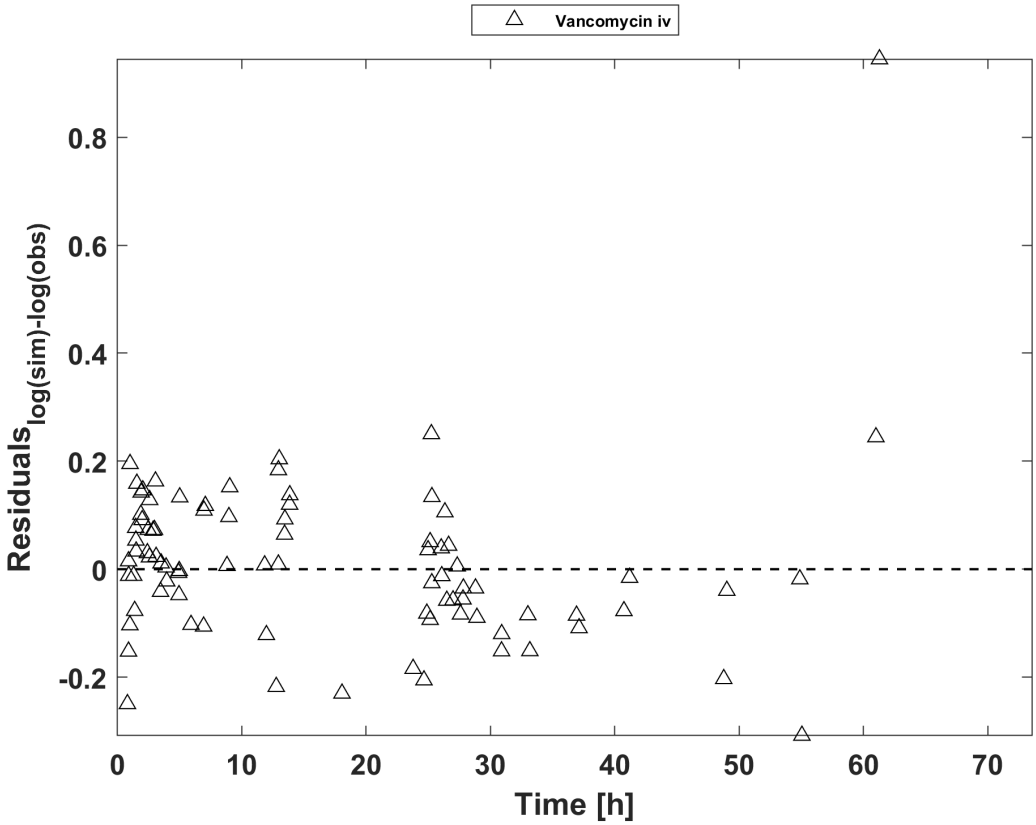
Name	Value	Value Origin
Fraction unbound (experiment)	0.67	
Lipophilicity (experiment)	2.45 Log Units	
Plasma clearance	0.11 ml/min/kg	
Specific clearance	0 1/min	Parameter Identification-Parameter Identification-Value updated from 'Parameter Identification 3' on 2018-07-13 11:16

3.2 Vancomycin Diagnostics Plots

Below you find the goodness-of-fit visual diagnostic plots for vancomycin PBPK model performance (observed versus individually simulated plasma concentration and weighted residuals versus time, including the geometric mean fold error (GMFE)) of all data used for model building.



Goodness of fit plor for concentration in plasma.

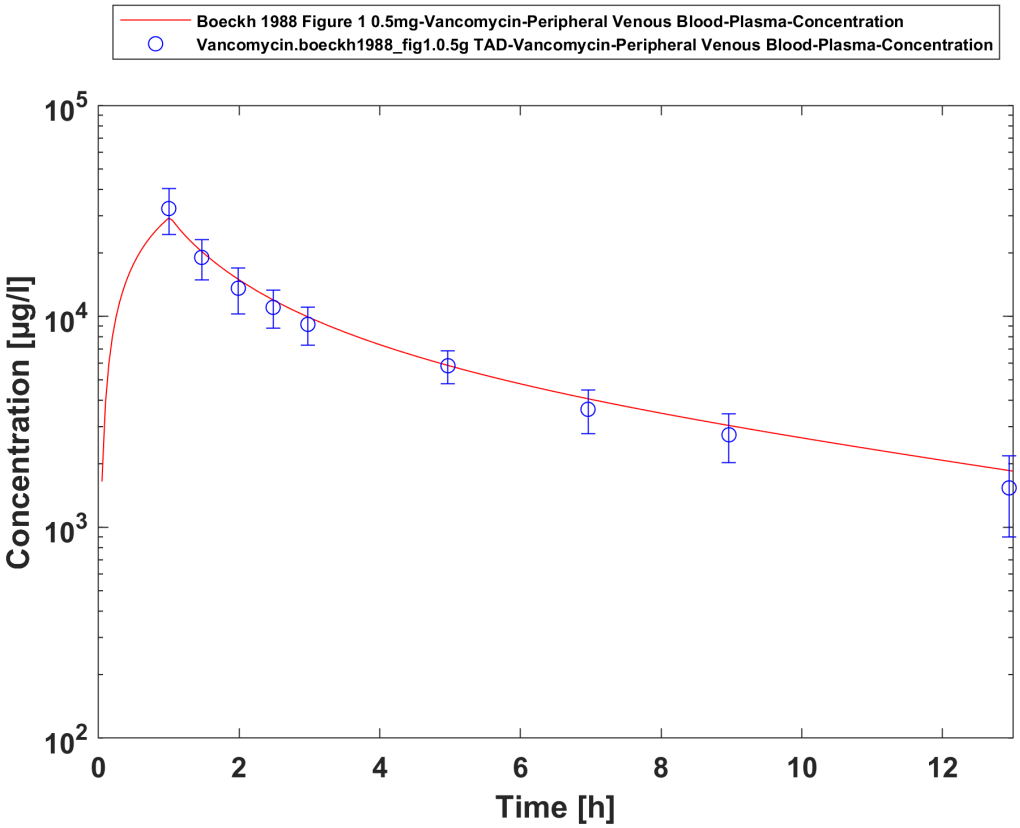


Goodness of fit plor for concentration in plasma.

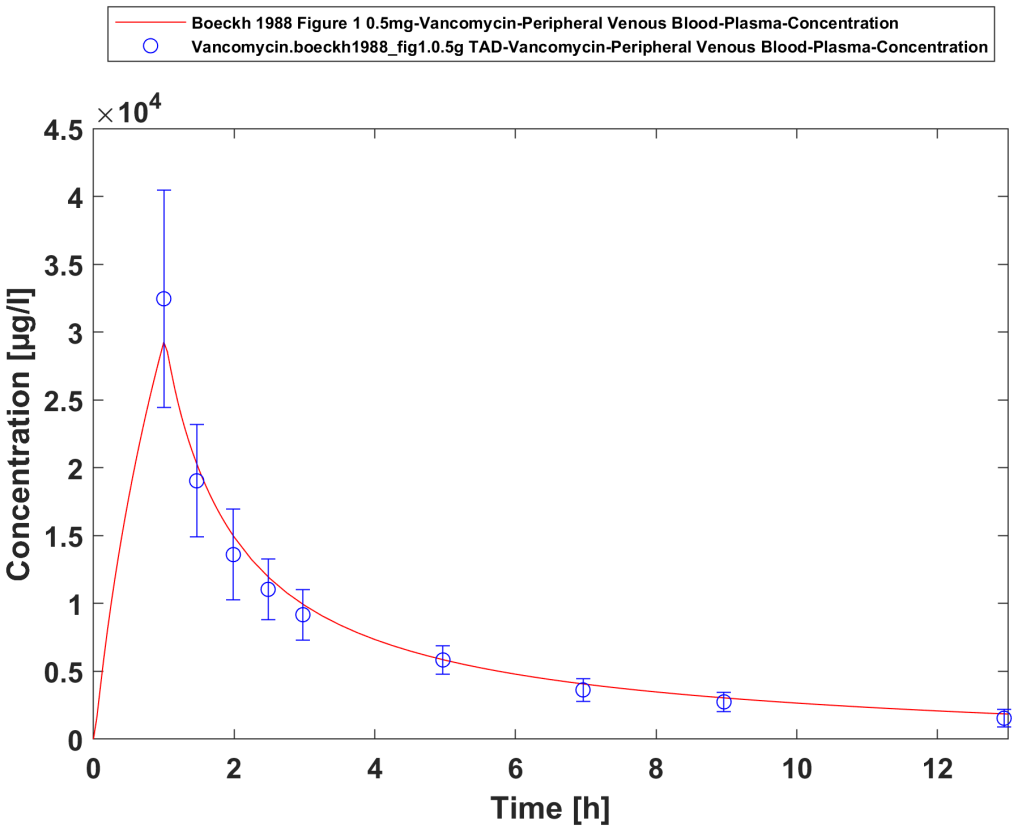
GMFE = 1.108921

3.3 Vancomycin Concentration-Time profiles

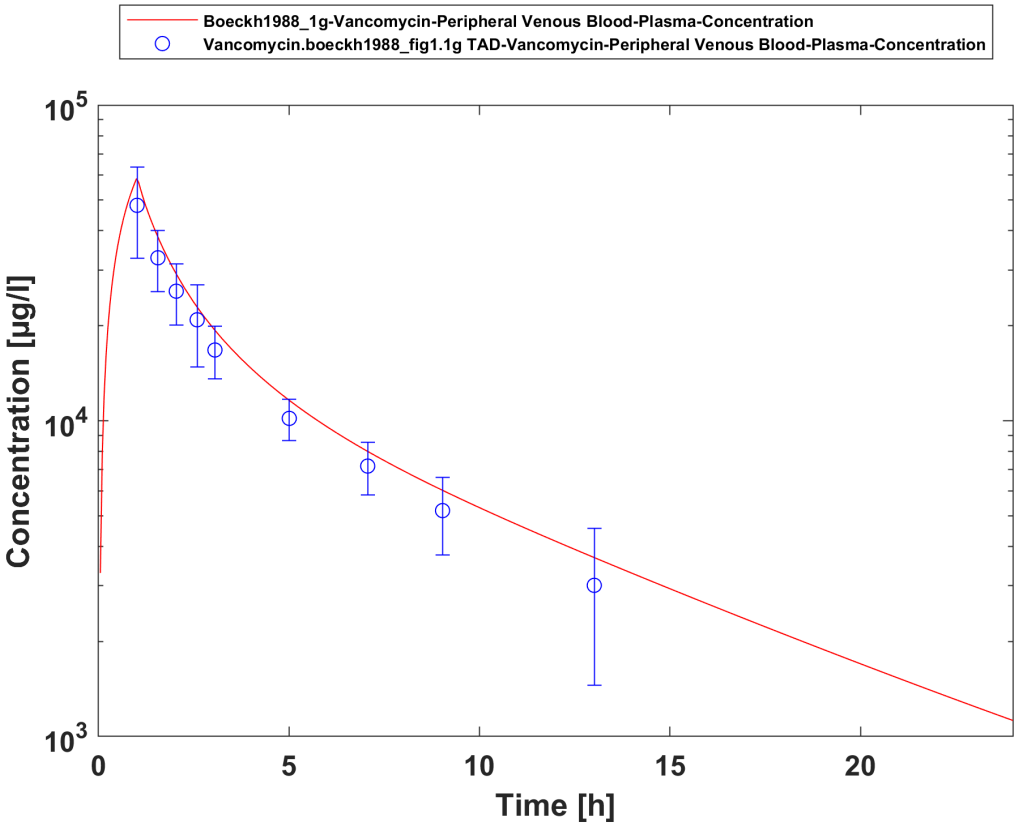
Simulated versus observed plasma concentration-time profiles of all data are listed below.



Time Profile Analysis



Time Profile Analysis 1



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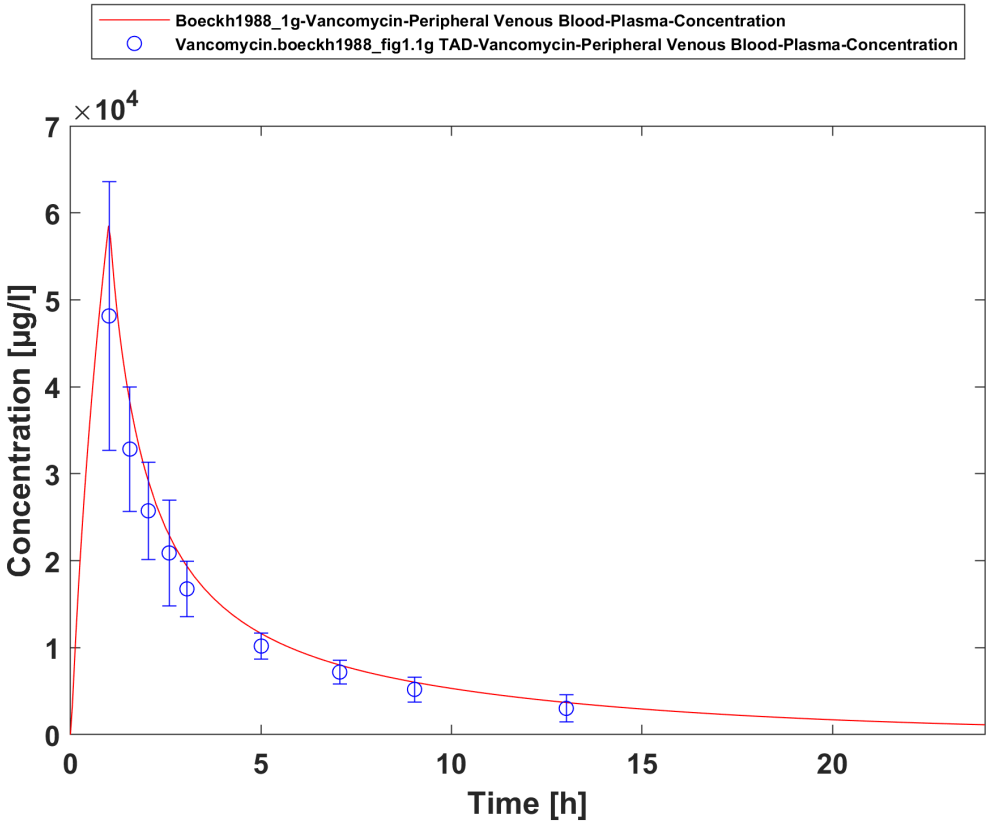
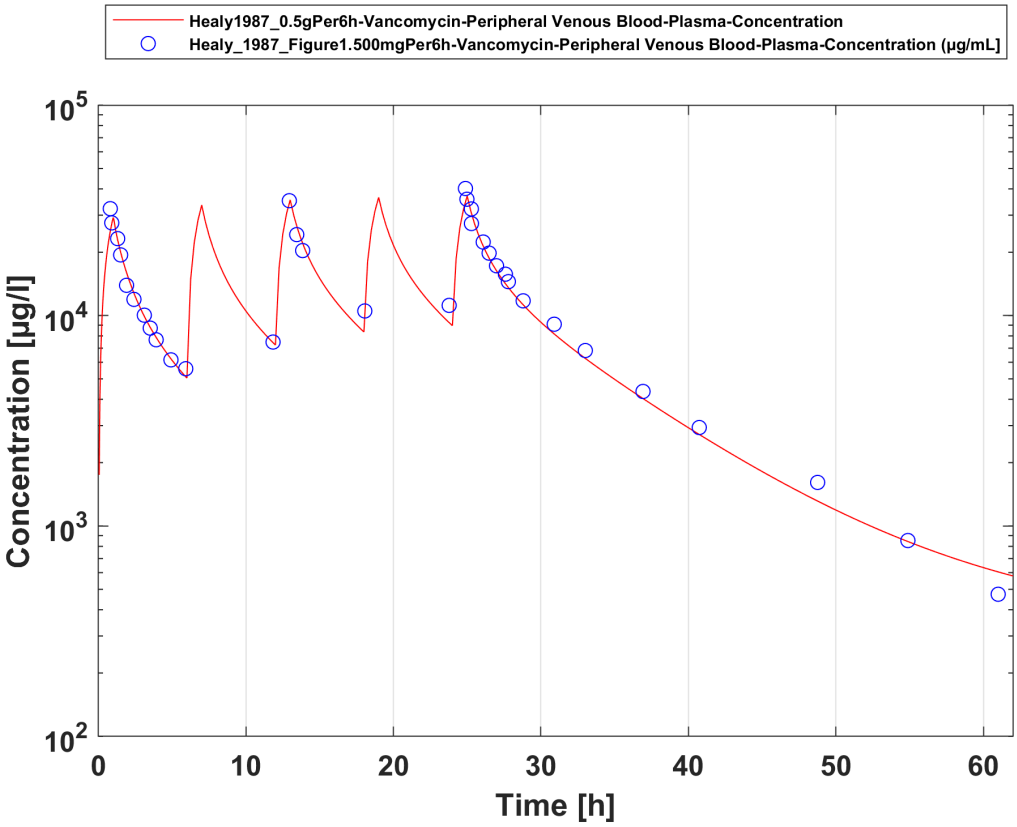


Time Profile Analysis 1



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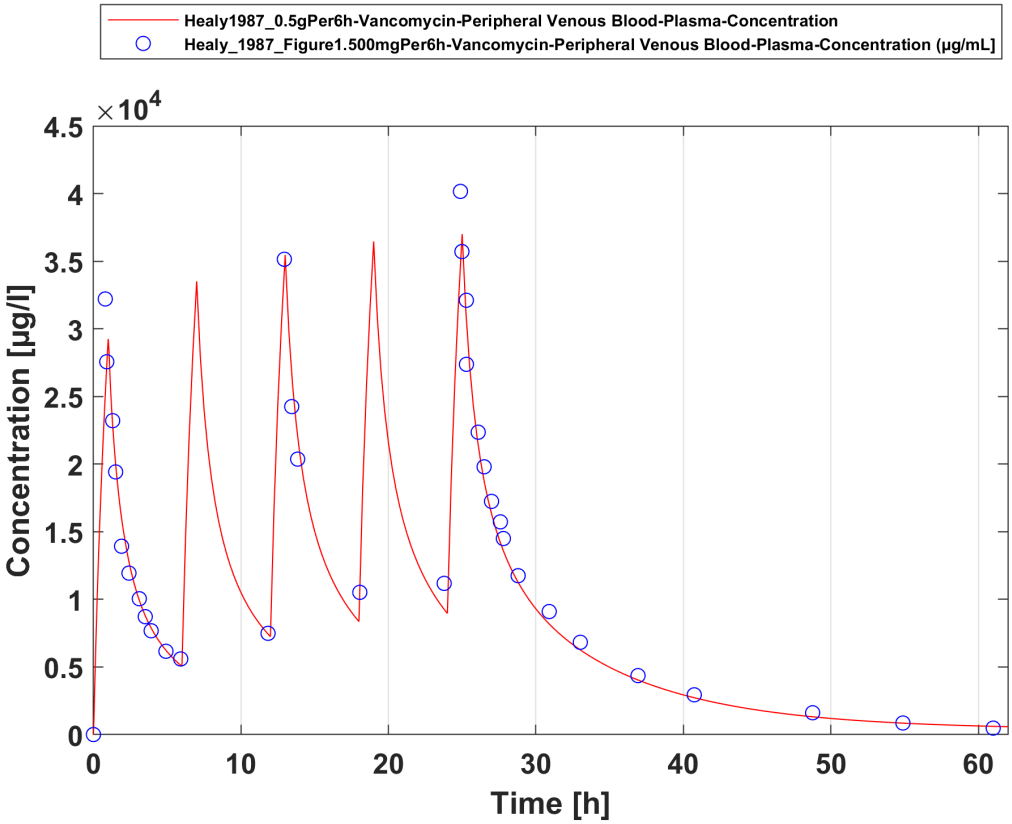
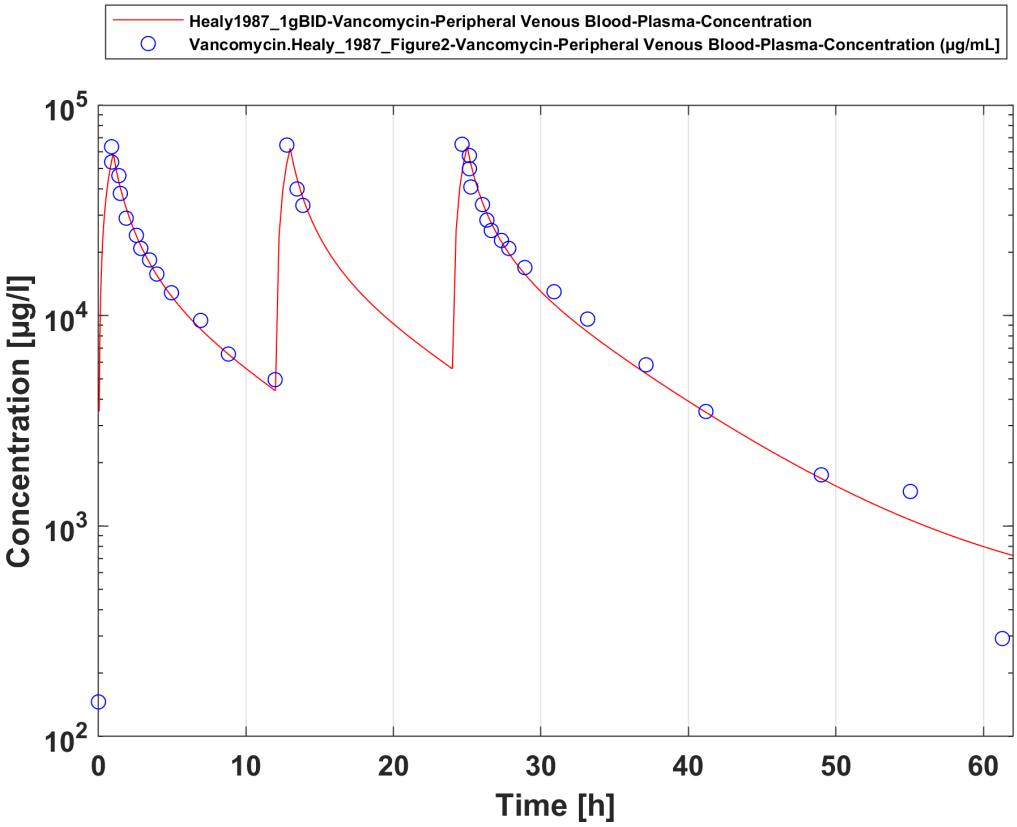
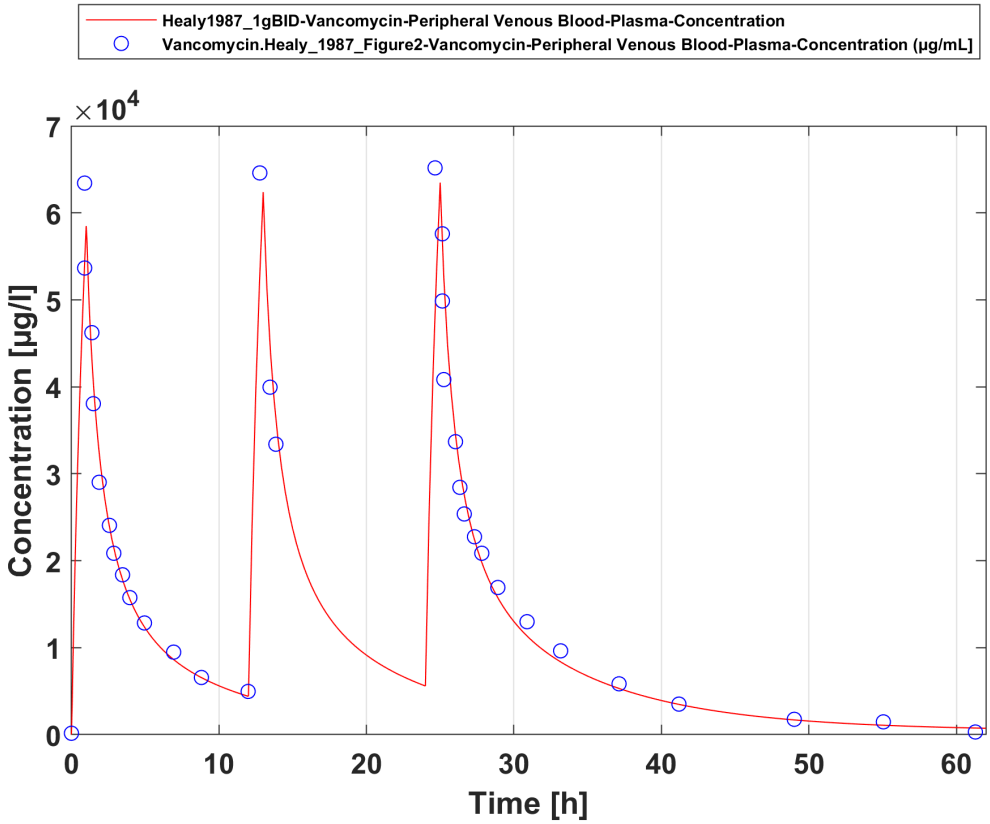


Time Profile Analysis 1



Time Profile Analysis



Time Profile Analysis 1

4 Conclusion

The final vancomycin PBPK model applies elimination by glomerular filtration and adequately describes the pharmacokinetics of vancomycin in adults receiving SD, MD of vancomycin ranging from 500mg to 1000mg intravenously.

This model could be applied for the investigation of drug-drug interactions (DDI), and translation to special populations such as pediatrics with regard GFR based elimination.

5 References

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